SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #8 · WEALTH AND PRIVILEGE

“People only like me for my money.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Being asked for loans, gifts, or favors, watching friends change after a promotion or inheritance, or seeing someone use a relationship for gain can make it hard to trust anyone. Family conflict over money can also teach us that affection comes with strings. Some suspicion is wise, but when it turns into a rule that applies to everyone, it can leave a person lonely in a crowd.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is realistic that a crowd of companions can lead to ruin. It also says that a friend loves at all times and that there is a friend who stays closer than a brother. Samuel was told that people look at outward things, but the Lord looks at the heart. Jesus called His followers friends and laid down His life for them. These passages do not ask us to be naive. They invite us to look for love that is tested over time, to be a true friend ourselves, and to trust the One who loves us for who we are.

> *“A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for adversity”* (Proverbs 17:17).

Also see

> “But the LORD said to Samuel, ‘Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.’” (1 Samuel 16:7).

> “A man of many companions may come to ruin, but there is a friend who stays closer than a brother” (Proverbs 18:24).

> “Greater love has no one than this, that he lay down his life for his friends” (John 15:13).

> “Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!” (Ecclesiastes 4:9–10).

Common self-statements

- If I had less, no one would be around.
- Everyone wants something from me.
- I cannot tell who is sincere.
- I am safer keeping people at a distance.
- Nobody would choose me for me.
- Being generous only attracts users.

Common logical errors

- Mind reading: Assuming I know that others are only after my money.
- Overgeneralizing: Turning a few painful experiences into a rule about everyone.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling suspicious and therefore concluding that I am being used.
- Discounting the positive: Dismissing real kindness as a trick.

Challenging questions

- Which relationships have lasted through hard times, whether or not money was involved?

- What specific evidence do I have about each person's motives?
- Have I ever been valued for something other than money?
- What are the signs of a friend who is true?
- How could I test trust slowly and wisely?
- Am I treating good people as if they were the ones who hurt me?

Truth summary

> Some people have used me, and wisdom is not the same as fear. But not everyone is the same. God loves me for who I am, and there are people who love me for who I am too. I can use wise limits and still take small steps toward real friendship.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Friendship
- Love, For Others
- Trust
- Money
- Loneliness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Love
- Money/Riches

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

Love Take Me Over — Steven Curtis Chapman
Receiving God's love can shape loving action instead of fear or performance.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus — Keith and Kristyn Getty
This classic hymn invites direct, honest prayer with the Savior who carries our burdens.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "People only like me for my money"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People only like me for my money." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who has stayed with me through hard times?
- ☐ What evidence do I have about this person's motives?
- ☐ What boundary would help me feel safe?
- ☐ What is one small step toward trust?
- ☐ How can I be a true friend?
- ☐ Where has old hurt shaped how I see people now?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am loved by God for who I am.
- ☐ Not everyone has an agenda.
- ☐ Wise boundaries are good; walls are not.
- ☐ True friends show up over time.
- ☐ I can be a true friend myself.
- ☐ I can take small steps toward trust.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Proverbs 17:17
  "A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for adversity."
- ☐ 1 Samuel 16:7
  "But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.'"
- ☐ John 15:13
  "Greater love has no one than this, that he lay down his life for his friends."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Who showed up: Each week, write the name of one person who has been kind without any link to money and what they did.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Proverbs 17:17 becomes: "Sarah can write: "A friend loves at all times, and I can look for and become that kind of friend.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Friendship" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- ☐ List people who have been faithful. Write down the names of people who stayed in hard seasons and what they did.
- ☐ Set one wise boundary. Decide ahead what you will and will not give, so you can be generous without resentment.
- ☐ Take one small step toward a friend. Invite someone for coffee or a walk with no agenda and notice how it goes.
- ☐ Be the friend. Do one kind thing this week for someone without telling anyone.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "People only like me for my money": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A true friend moment
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People only like me for my money.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You love me for who I am. Heal the places where I have been used. Give me wisdom to set good boundaries, courage to trust slowly, and the joy of being a true friend. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.